

A

Making accusations

A government minister is today **facing accusations** of taking bribes. There have been **heavy hints**¹ about this for some time. An article in *The Moon* last week **clearly implied**² that a top political figure was involved in a scandal and **dropped** a number of **broad hints**³ as to who it was. A **leaked document**⁴ published in today's *Moon*, however, **makes** a number of **serious allegations**⁵, which **openly accuse** the Minister of corruption. The Minister has **issued a statement**⁶, saying **the claims are unfounded**⁷. He claims that he has been **wrongly accused** by *The Moon* because of its **long-running battle**⁸ with the government.



¹ strong suggestions

² suggested clearly but indirectly

³ made a number of obvious suggestions

⁴ an official document unofficially given to the press

⁵ makes serious claims of criminal behaviour

⁶ made a formal statement

⁷ the claims are untrue, have no basis in reality

⁸ an argument that has been going on for a long time

B

Putting forward a point of view

Jones **puts forward** an interesting **theory**¹ of language learning, **backing up**² his **argument** with thorough data. **Fully accepting** the fact that different learners find different methods useful, Jones **makes the point**³ that motivation is the key factor in most learners' success. Although this has been **widely acknowledged**⁴ in general terms for some time, Jones is more precise than most, **stating clearly** that motivation is more important than all other factors, and **substantiating**⁵ this **claim** with impressive data.

¹ proposes a theory

² supporting

³ presents an argument

⁴ accepted by many people

⁵ supporting

C

Denying

collocation	example
strongly deny	The PM strongly denied claims of corruption made against him.
deny charges / an accusation	Despite the evidence against him, the accused denied the charges .
deny a rumour / an allegation	The pop star has denied all the rumours about her marriage.
disclaim responsibility	The hotel disclaims all responsibility for guests' vehicles.
reject an idea / a suggestion	Ann rejected all Joe's suggestions about how to decorate their flat.
run contrary to	The research findings run contrary to popular belief.
contradictory evidence/advice	Contradictory evidence made it hard for the jury to reach a verdict.

Common mistakes

Note these collocations: **deny/reject a claim**, **deny a rumour / an allegation / an accusation** but **reject an idea / a suggestion** and **refuse an invitation/offer**. You **deny/reject/refuse something**. You **deny that something** is true. You can also **refuse to do something** (in the future) but **deny doing something** (in the past).

Exercises

58.1 Complete the sentences, using collocations from A.

- 1 A provided the press with information about the government's secret plans.
- 2 Management has been having a with trade union representatives over a number of aspects of employees' rights.
- 3 I'm going to get my son a racing bike for his birthday. He's been dropping about what he wants for some time.
- 4 At the end of the three-day meeting a spokesperson will to inform the press about any agreements that have been signed.
- 5 A front-page article in today's paper is making some about the behaviour of some top international bankers.
- 6 The article did not name anyone directly but it who was involved.

58.2 Fill each gap in this extract from a scientific article.

In his latest article on the free market Milton King puts (1) some original theories. He (2) earlier ideas which up until now most economists have accepted without question. He (3) some fascinating points based on his own extensive research which is widely (4) as an important contribution to economic thought. The data from his research (5) up his theories and help to (6) his claim that modern economies would benefit from major reforms.

58.3 Replace the underlined words with an appropriate form of either *deny*, *reject* or *refuse* to give the sentences the opposite meaning.

- 1 The politician agreed that the allegations made against him were true.
- 2 I think we should accept Jill's invitation to their New Year's Party, don't you?
- 3 Hill accepts the theories put forward by Jackson.
- 4 Katie agreed that she had been present at the meeting.
- 5 I hope they will accept my offer of help.

58.4 Rewrite each sentence using the word in brackets, so that it keeps the same meaning.

- 1 We are not responsible for valuables that are not left in the hotel safe. (DISCLAIM)
- 2 The pop star insisted that there was no basis to the claims made against him. (UNFOUNDED)
- 3 Jones's views do not accord with the facts. (RUN)
- 4 The newspaper clearly suggested who the actor's new partner was. (DROPPED)
- 5 John insisted that what people were saying about him was untrue. (DENIED)
- 6 Whatever idea I suggest, Daniel says it is no good. (REJECTS)
- 7 I don't know what to do, as everyone keeps suggesting I do something different. (CONTRADICTION)
- 8 The student is being accused of cheating in the exam. (FACING)
- 9 In her new book the writer presents an interesting theory of art. (FORWARD)
- 10 Recent research supports McIntyre's theory. (UP)